



INTERNAL OPERATIONS REFERENCE

Wildshakes

Operations Handbook

A complete guide to the Master Admin / Franchiser / Commissary Web Portal and the Wildshakes Point-of-Sale (POS) application — for franchise owners, commissary managers, and store staff.

[Web Admin Portal](#)

[POS System](#)

[v1.0 · 2026](#)

Prepared for Wildshakes Cafe & Franchise Network · Confidential — Internal Use Only

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Note on screenshots: every screenshot in this guide is captured directly from the real, working application — nothing is a drawing or a guess. The Master Admin, Franchiser and Commissary dashboard examples were taken using temporary preview accounts made just for this handbook and removed again right after, so a couple of those screens show a brand-new account with no activity yet, rather than a busy real branch.

1. System Overview & Architecture

Wildshakes runs on two connected applications that share one central system for all company information: a **web Admin Portal** used by Head Office, franchise owners and commissary managers on a desktop or laptop, and a **POS app** (installed on an Android tablet at each branch) used by cashiers and managers to take orders.

1.1 The two applications

APPLICATION	WHO USES IT	WHAT IT'S FOR
Web Admin Portal Used on a computer or laptop	Master Admin (Head Office), Franchise owners, Commissary managers, and any staff they grant "portal access" to	Franchise & commissary management, inventory and shipment tracking, sales analytics, staff management, menu management, and company-wide announcements.
POS App Android tablet, works with or without internet	Cashiers, Managers, Investors (silent co-owners) at each branch	Taking dine-in / take-out / delivery orders, processing payments, printing receipts and kitchen tickets, holding orders, and (for managers) voiding transactions and reviewing sales.

1.2 How the three portal tiers relate

The web portal is **one website shared by three different account types**. Signing in always takes you to a dashboard page first, and the system immediately sends you to the right area for your account type:

- **Master Admin** ("God Mode") — Wildshakes Head Office. Full visibility into every franchise and commissary branch: company-wide analytics, franchise sign-up, the commissary supply chain, financials, and company-wide broadcasts.
- **Franchiser** — an individual franchise owner. Limited strictly to their own branch(es): sales, inventory, staff, menu availability, POS device, transactions, and HQ announcements.
- **Commissary** — a regional commissary hub that supplies a group of franchisees. Limited to their own franchisee network: shipments, inventory tagging, and network sales reports.

Guardrail: a Franchiser account can never see another franchise's data, and a Commissary account can never see franchisees that aren't assigned to it — this is enforced on every page, not just hidden in the menu.

1.3 Staff sub-accounts & "panels"

Any of the three account owners (Master Admin, a franchise owner, or a commissary manager) can create **staff accounts** and give them web portal access to a hand-picked set of pages — called **panels**. A staff member only sees the panels they were specifically given; everything else sends them to an "Access Denied" page. Creating staff, changing their panels, or taking away their portal access is **always limited to the real owner** — even a staff member who happens to have every panel turned on cannot manage other staff.

ACCOUNT TYPE	AVAILABLE PANELS A STAFF MEMBER CAN BE GRANTED
Franchise	Dashboard, Sales Reports, Transactions, Inventory, My Staff, Menu Availability, POS Device, Announcements
Commissary	Dashboard, Franchisees, Shipments, Inventory, Reports
Master Admin	Dashboard, Franchises, Commissary, Menu, Financials, Broadcast

1.4 The POS app works with or without internet

The tablet at each branch is designed to **never stop selling**, even with no internet connection. Every action a cashier takes — completing a sale, holding an order, voiding a transaction — is saved on the tablet itself right away, then quietly sent to head office's system in the background. A status bar in the top-right of the POS screen always shows whether the device is currently **ONLINE** or **OFFLINE**, and how many sales are still waiting to go through. Section B8 explains this in detail.

2. Roles & Permissions Model

There are two independent role systems in Wildshakes: the **web portal role** (who can log into the admin site, and what they can see there) and the **POS role** (who can log into the tablet, and what they can do at the register). A person can hold both — e.g. a franchise owner also has a POS-capable account for training purposes, and a cashier can additionally be granted web portal access to one or two panels.

2.1 Web portal roles

ROLE	SCOPE	NOTES
Master Admin	Entire company — all franchises, all commissaries	Only Master Admin can register new franchises or commissary branches, and send global broadcasts.
Franchisee (owner)	Their own franchise's branches	Can order inventory from a commissary, manage their own staff, and control menu availability at their branch.
Commissary (manager)	Their assigned franchisee network	Ships inventory to franchisees, tags catalog items to specific branches, and reports on their network's sales.
Staff (portal sub-account)	Whatever panels were granted, within their owner's data only	Can never manage other staff or grant/take away portal access, regardless of which panels they hold.

2.2 POS (tablet) roles

ROLE	CAN DO
Cashier	Take orders, apply Senior/PWD/Custom discounts, checkout, hold orders. Voiding a sale, applying the "Manager" discount tier, viewing Transactions, or releasing the device all require a Manager PIN.
Manager	Everything a cashier can do, plus: void transactions, approve the Manager discount tier, view the Transactions history, release the POS device, and authorize other cashiers' manager-gated actions by entering their own PIN.
Investor	Same authorization powers as Manager (silent co-owner role) — can approve manager-gated actions but is intended as a passive, oversight-only role.

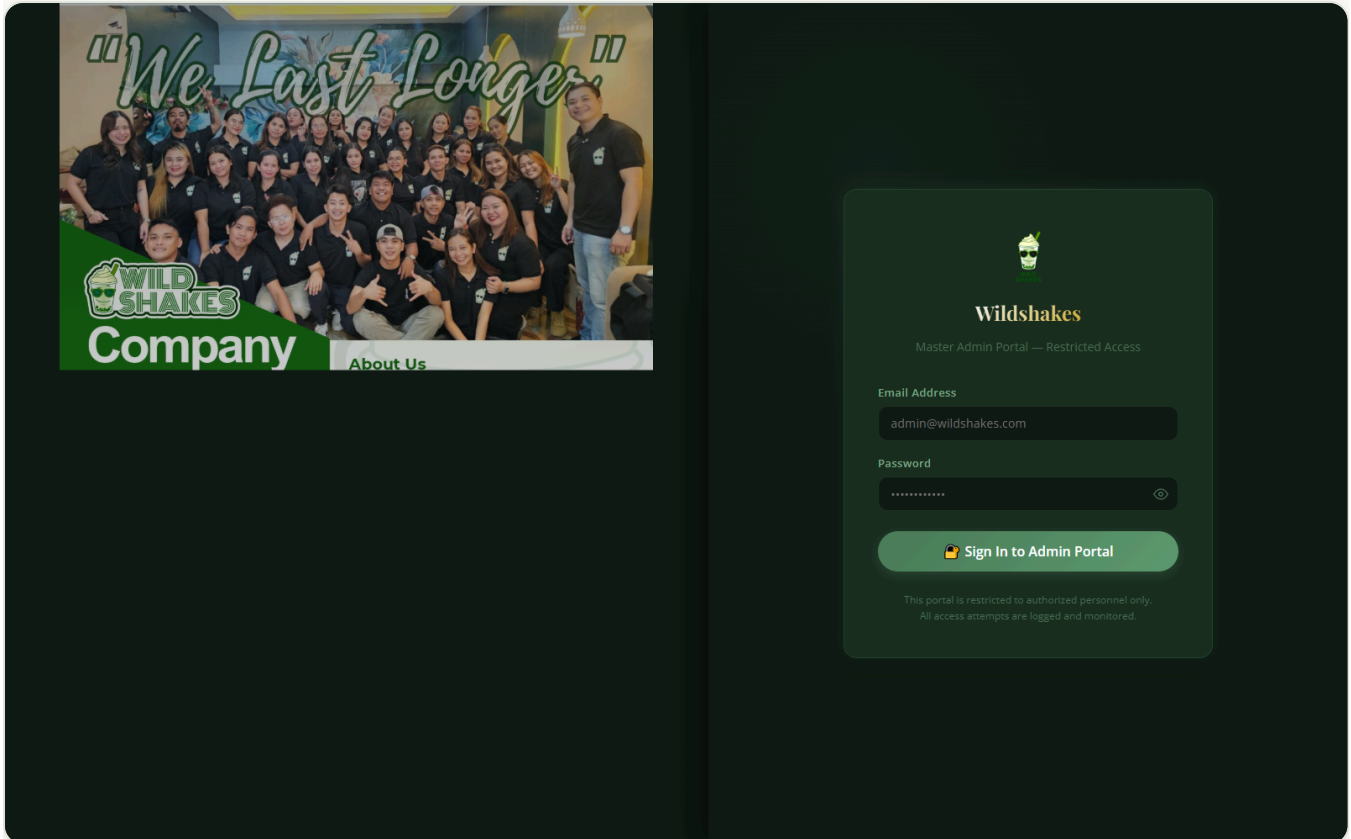
PIN hygiene: the staff-creation form in the Franchiser portal rejects obviously weak PINs — all-same-digit (e.g. 111111) and simple sequential runs (123456, 654321) are blocked at entry.

Web Admin Portal

Master Admin · Franchiser · Commissary — one website, three different views depending on who's signed in.

Ao. Signing In & Access Control

Every visit to the portal starts at the login page. It's deliberately labelled "Restricted Access" — this portal is for staff only, not customers.



LIVE SCREENSHOT

The Admin Portal login screen. All sign-in attempts are logged; on failure the portal shows a generic "Invalid credentials. Access denied." rather than revealing which field was wrong.

After entering your email and password and pressing " **Sign In to Admin Portal,**" the system checks what kind of account you have and sends you to the right place automatically:

- Role master_admin → /dashboard (Command Center)
- Role franchisee → /franchiser/dashboard
- Role commissary → /commissary-portal/dashboard
- Any other / deactivated account → the Access Denied page below



Access Denied

Your account does not have permission to access the Master Admin Portal. This incident has been logged.

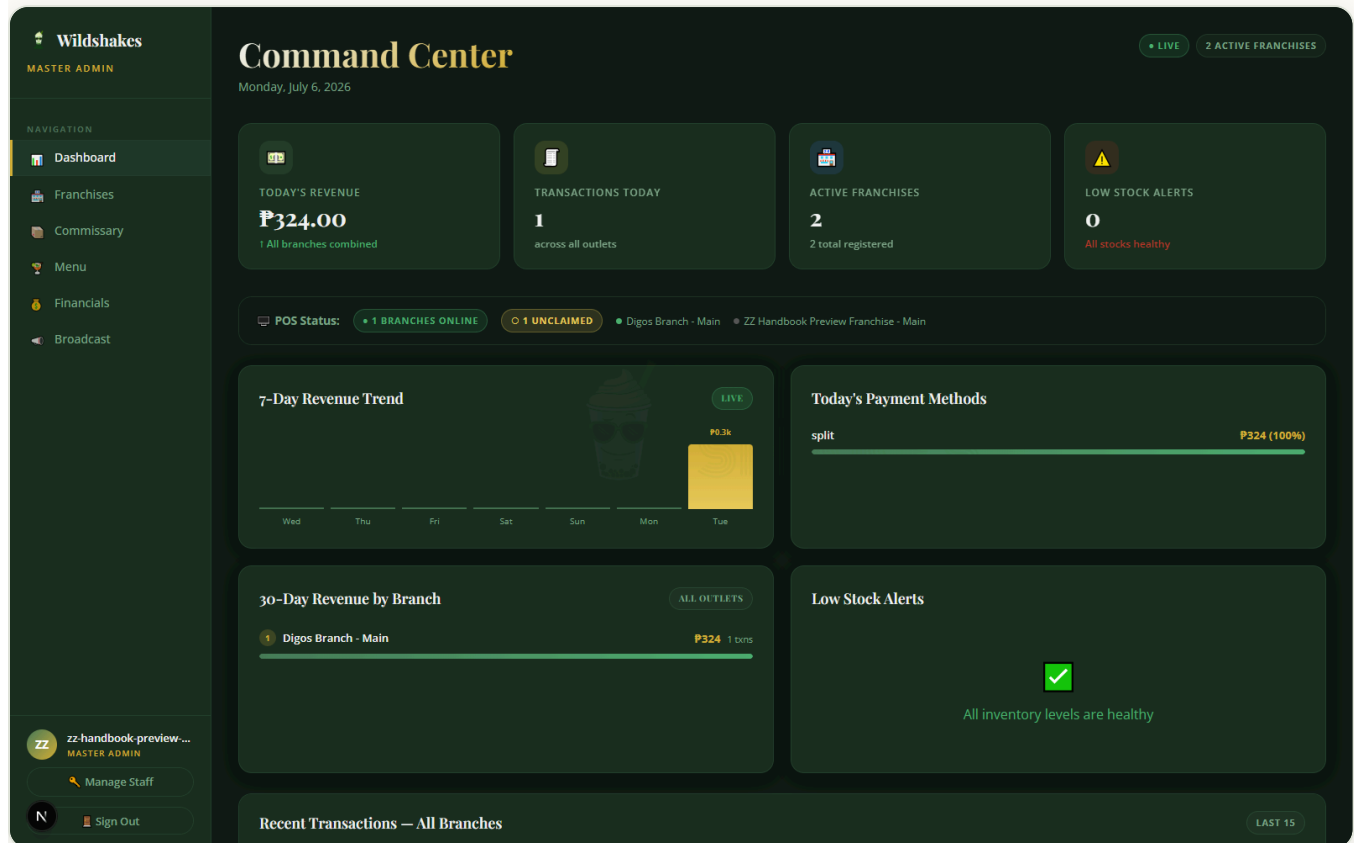
[← Return to Login](#)

LIVE SCREENSHOT

Shown to any account without a recognized portal role, or a staff account whose portal access has since been taken away. This check happens every single time a page opens — an account that's been cut off is locked out right away, with no delay.

A1. Master Admin — Command Center

The landing page for Head Office. A single screen answers "how is the whole company doing right now."



LIVE SCREENSHOT The real Command Center, captured with a temporary preview account — the figures shown (P324 revenue, 2 franchises, 1 branch online) reflect the company's actual data at the moment this was taken.

What's on this page

- **Top summary cards:** Today's Revenue (calculated using Philippine time starting at midnight, so the "day" always matches local business hours), Transactions Today, Active Franchises (vs. total registered), and Low Stock Alerts.
- **POS Status banner:** a live-updating strip showing how many branch tablets are currently online vs. unclaimed, with a colored dot per branch.
- **7-Day Revenue Trend** and **Today's Payment Methods** charts, plus a **30-Day Revenue by Branch** leaderboard and a **Low Stock Alerts** panel (top 6 ingredients closest to running out, with their branch).
- **Recent Transactions — All Branches:** the last 15 sales company-wide, with cashier, amount, payment method and status.

The sidebar navigation (Dashboard, Franchises, Commissary, Menu Management, Financial Analytics, Global Broadcast) is filtered to whatever panels your account — or your staff panel grant — actually has.

A1.2 Franchise Management

This is where Head Office **signs up new franchises and commissary branches**. It has two tabs: "🏠 Franchises" and "🏠 Commissary Branches," each with its own search box and status/actions column (Activate / Suspend).

Wildshakes
MASTER ADMIN

Franchise Management
Manage franchisee partners and commissary branches

[Register Franchise](#)

Summary Cards:

- TOTAL FRANCHISES: 2
- COMMISSARY BRANCHES: 2
- TOTAL BRANCHES: 2
- POS ONLINE: 1

Franchises (2) | Commissary Branches (2)

All Franchises

FRANCHISE	OWNER	PARENT	REGION	BRANCHES	STATUS	REGISTERED	ACTIONS
ZZ Handbook Preview Franchise zz-handbook-preview-franchisee-1783350292116@wildshakes.invalid	Preview Franchise Owner	★ MAIN ADMIN	Preview Region	ZZ Handbook Preview Franchise - Main	ACTIVE	7/6/2026	Suspend
Digos Branch clyde@wildshakes23.com	Clyde Lian	★ MAIN ADMIN	Digos City	Digos Branch - Main POS	ACTIVE	6/8/2026	Suspend

Navigation: Dashboard, Franchises, Commissary, Menu, Financials, Broadcast

User Profile: zz-handbook-preview-... MASTER ADMIN, [Manage Staff](#), [Sign Out](#)

LIVE SCREENSHOT The real Franchise Management screen, showing the actual Digos Branch alongside a temporary preview franchise created for this handbook (since removed).

Registering a new franchise

The "✚ **Register Franchise**" pop-up collects the franchise name, region, owner name and email, an optional parent commissary (or "Direct under Main Admin"), and a portal password (minimum 8 characters). Submitting it:

- Sets up the new franchise in the system
- Creates a new login account for the owner with the Franchisee role
- Automatically creates a first branch named "{Franchise Name} - Main"
- Shows the new login email + password once, so it can be handed to the new owner

Registering a commissary branch works the same way, via "🏠 **Add Commissary Branch**," and creates a Commissary-role login instead.

Franchise detail page

Clicking into a franchise opens six tabs: **Dashboard, Sales, Transactions, Staff, Stock, Inventory**. Everything here is for **viewing only** — Head Office cannot make changes from this screen. The Stock and Inventory tabs are labelled "🔒 View only — franchisee controls stock" and "🔒 Read-only — today's snapshot," since day-to-day stock control belongs to the franchisee, not HQ.

A1.3 Commissary & Supply Chain

Head Office's central inventory and shipment control tool, with three tabs:

TAB	WHAT IT DOES
 Live Stock	Every commissary's current ingredient levels, grouped by branch, filterable by sheet type (Commissary, Food, Production, Coffee, Shake...) and by status (All / Low / Out). Each item can be tagged to specific franchise branches so it only appears in their inventory sheet.
 Shipments	Every shipment ever created, with clickable stat cards (Pending / In Transit / Received / Rejected) that filter the table. A shipment starts life as Pending ; clicking " Send " marks it In Transit and the receiving franchisee then Receives or Rejects it on their end.
 Item Catalog	The master list of everything the commissary can ship, organized by category, with a Hide/Show toggle per item and the same branch-tagging control.

Why tagging matters: an item with no tags is visible to every branch by default. Tagging restricts visibility to only the branches selected — this is how Head Office runs region-specific catalogs (e.g. an item only Cebu branches should see) without creating separate systems per region.

A1.4 – A1.7 Financials, Staff, Broadcast & Menu

Financial Analytics

Company-wide revenue reporting with a date-range selector (7 / 30 / 90 days or last 12 months) and a branch filter, three headline stats (Gross Revenue, Total Discounts, Net Revenue), revenue-by-branch and revenue-by-payment-method charts, and a " **Export CSV**" button for pulling the underlying transaction detail into a spreadsheet.

Staff Management

Owner-only, with no panel key that could ever be delegated — this page cannot be handed to a staff member no matter how the panel checkboxes are set. From here Head Office adds staff, sets which panels they can see, and activates/deactivates accounts.

Global Broadcast

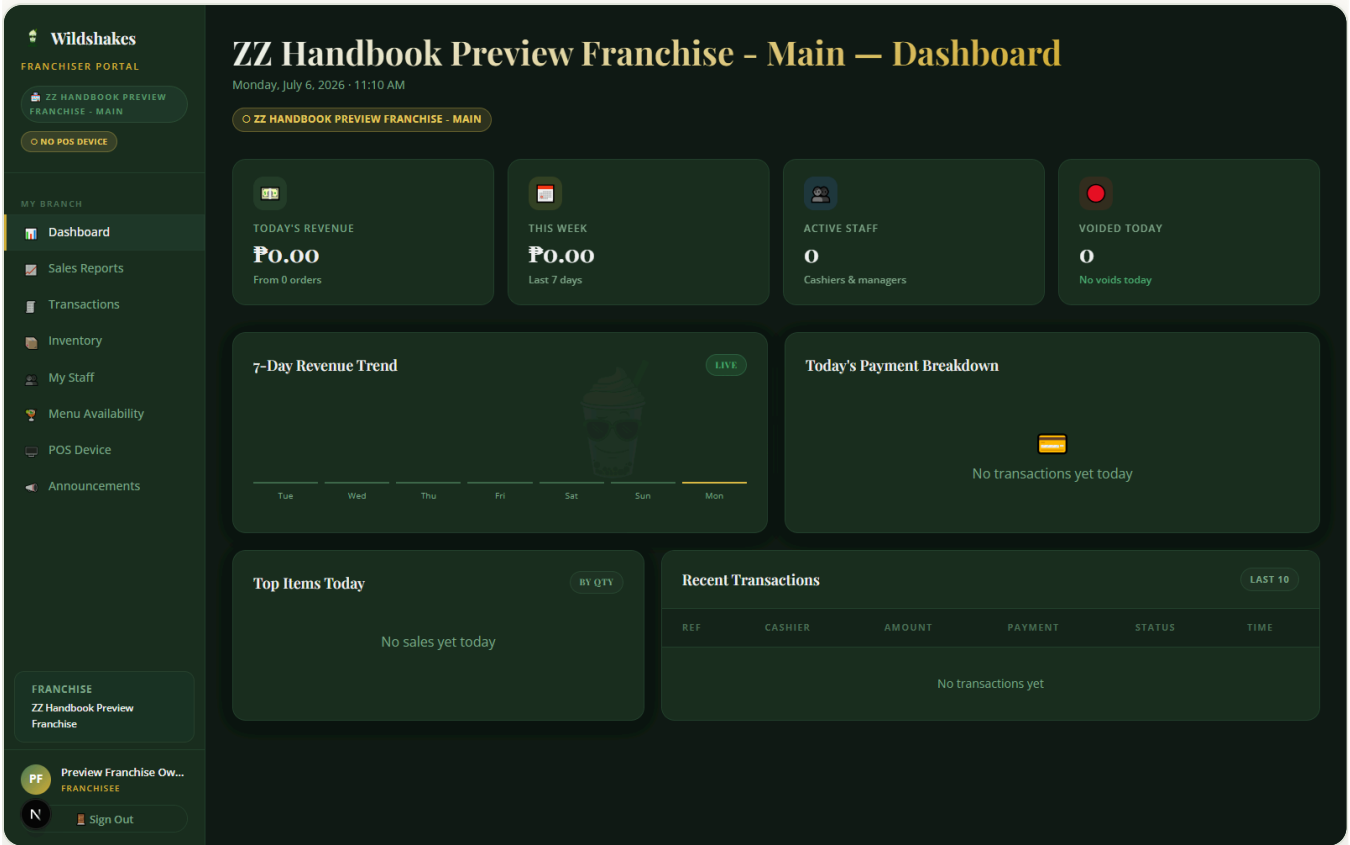
Composes a title, message body, priority (● Normal / ● High / ● Critical) and a target audience (● All Franchises, or one specific franchise). Sent broadcasts appear as high-priority alerts on every targeted franchiser's dashboard, and can be archived later from the same screen.

Menu Management

Controls the live POS menu and its reference pricing across two tabs: **POS Products** (add/edit/hide items, including a special filter for the FoodPanda & Grab delivery menu) and **Pricing Reference** (cost-per-serving, margin, and profit per item, which can be edited directly in the table).

A2. Franchiser Portal

What a franchise owner (or their delegated staff) sees — limited strictly to their own branch(es).



LIVE SCREENSHOT The real Franchiser Dashboard, captured with a temporary preview franchise created just for this handbook — that's why revenue, staff and transactions all show zero here. On a real, active branch these same cards fill in with today's revenue, active staff, top-selling items and recent sales.

What a franchisee can manage

PAGE	PURPOSE
Dashboard	Today's revenue, this week's revenue, active staff count, and any voided transactions requiring review.
Daily Inventory Check	A daily stock sheet across Menu Items, Food Items, Shakes, Coffee and Commissary items — Starting and Additional stock are entered manually; Sold, Cancelled and Voided quantities are filled in automatically based on POS sales, and Ending stock is worked out from those numbers. A "📄 Copy Yesterday's Ending " button fills in today's Starting stock all at once. A Recipe Import wizard (5 steps: Upload → Review → Match → Preview → Import) lets a franchisee bulk-import ingredient lists from a spreadsheet file.
Menu Availability	Turns items on/off at this branch specifically (names and prices are locked — those are Head Office's to manage). A "✓ Mark All Available" button clears every out-of-stock flag at once.
POS Device	Shows whether a tablet is currently bound to the branch, lets the owner download the POS APK, and — with a confirm-twice safety pattern — "🔒 Release Device" to log the tablet out

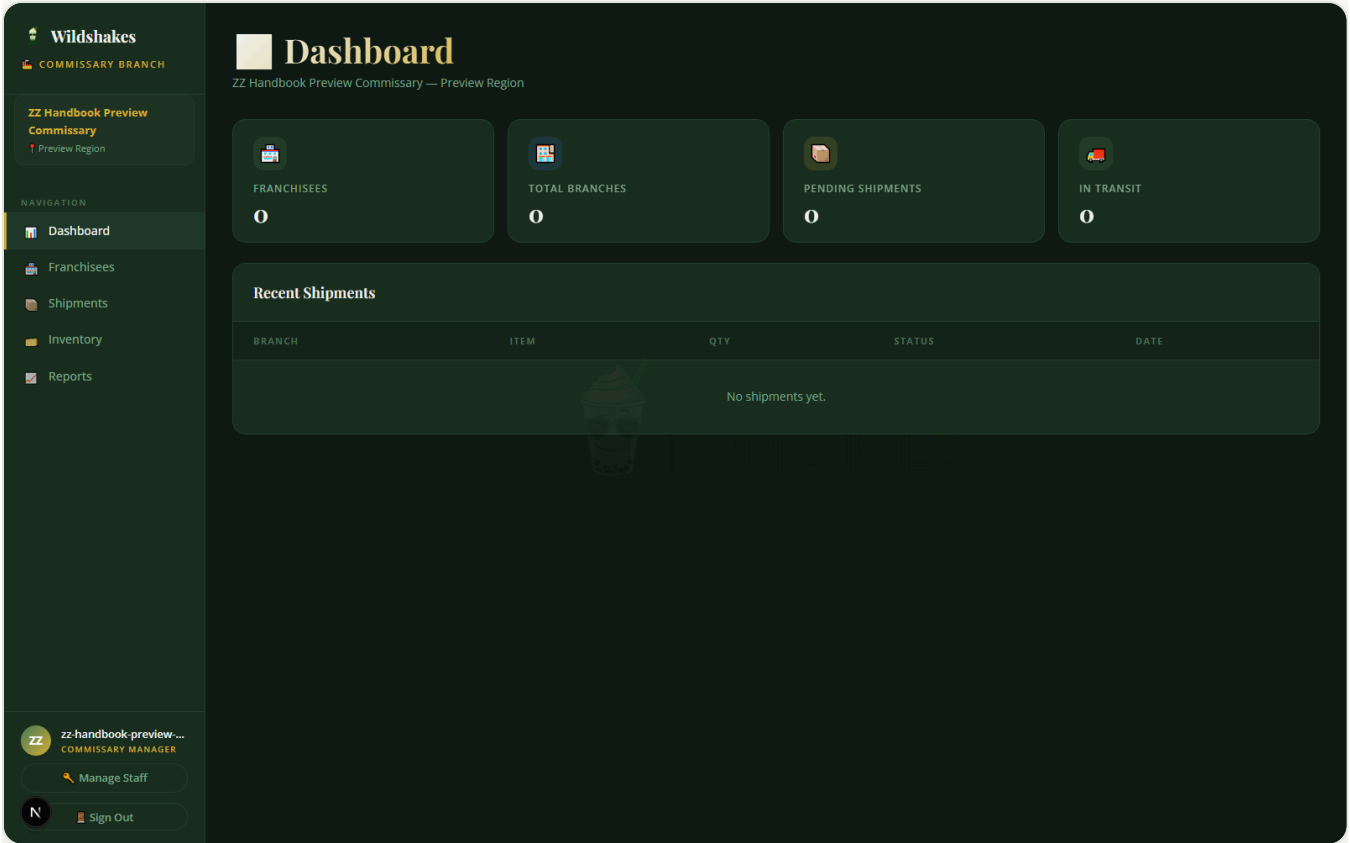
so it (or a replacement) can be re-registered.

Sales Report	Gross/Net revenue, average order value, a payment-method breakdown, a FoodPanda/Grab delivery breakdown when applicable, and CSV export.
My Staff	Add cashiers, managers, baristas, kitchen staff, riders, etc.; set 6-digit PINs (required only for Cashier and Manager roles); generate a scannable QR login card per staff member; and optionally grant a staff member web portal access to specific panels.
Transaction History	Every sale at this branch with filters for status, date range, and search by reference/cashier; each entry expands to show the individual items, and cancelled items are shown struck-through and marked "not charged."
Announcements	A view-only feed of Head Office broadcasts targeted at "all franchises" or specifically at this one.

Staff QR cards: each staff member can be issued a printable QR code as an alternative to typing a PIN at the POS login screen. The generator warns "Keep this private — it grants full {role} access," since scanning it authenticates exactly like the PIN would.

A3. Commissary Portal

What a regional commissary manager sees — limited to the franchisees assigned to their hub.



LIVE SCREENSHOT The real Commissary Dashboard, captured with a temporary preview commissary created just for this handbook — that's why franchisee count, branches and shipments all show zero here. A commissary with franchisees already assigned to it would show real counts and a shipment history in these same cards.

PAGE	PURPOSE
Dashboard	Franchisee & branch counts, pending/in-transit shipment counts, and a recent-shipments table.
Franchisees	Register new franchisees under this commissary (same steps as Head Office's franchise registration, automatically linked to this commissary as their parent) and activate/suspend them.
Inventory	Stock Levels across a "📦 My Commissary" entry plus each franchisee's branches, and a Franchise Assignments tab for tagging catalog items to specific franchisee branches — restricted so a commissary manager can only ever tag their <i>own</i> franchisees, never change a tag that belongs to Head Office on someone else's branch.
Reports	Network-wide sales by franchisee with a custom date range, revenue share per franchisee, and a daily breakdown table.
Shipments	Create and track shipments to franchisee branches through the same Pending → In Transit → Received/Rejected pipeline used company-wide.

Staff

Owner-only, mirrors Head Office's Staff Management page exactly, limited to this commissary.

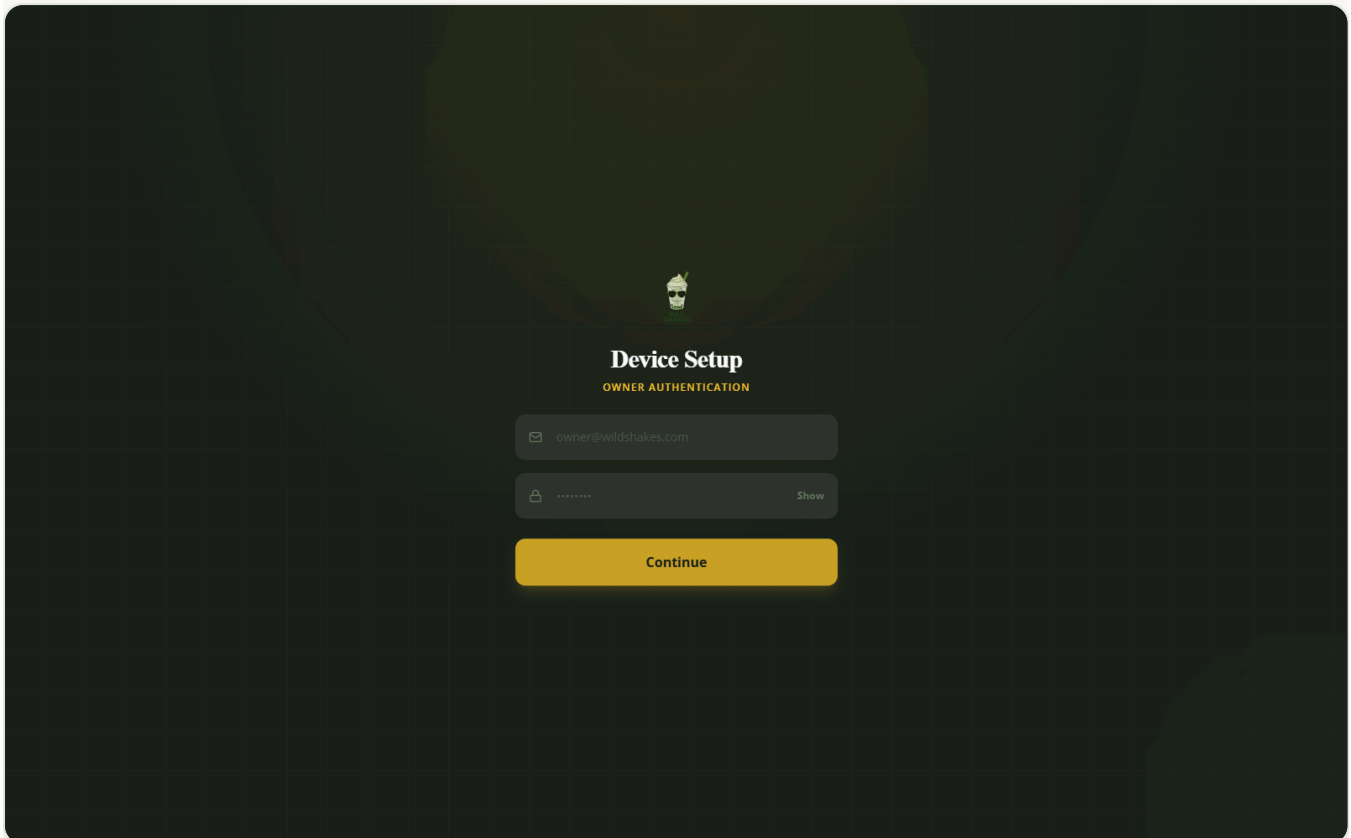
Point-of-Sale App

The Android tablet application cashiers use at the register — built to keep selling with or without an internet connection.

Bo. Device Setup & Sign-In

A brand-new tablet has to be **claimed** for a branch exactly once, by the franchise owner (or Master Admin). After that, cashiers sign in and out all day using just a PIN or QR card — the owner's credentials are never needed again on that device.

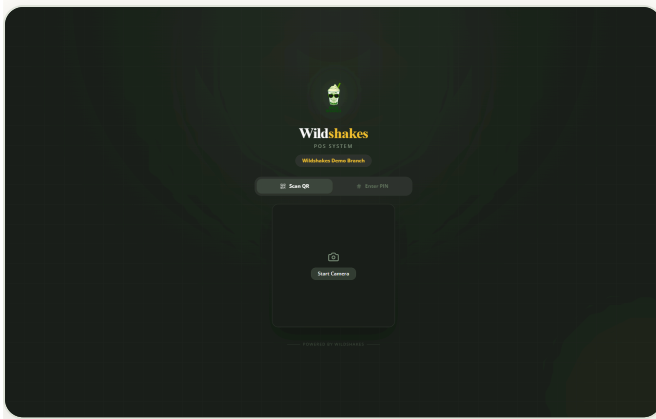
Step 1 — Owner Authentication

**LIVE SCREENSHOT**

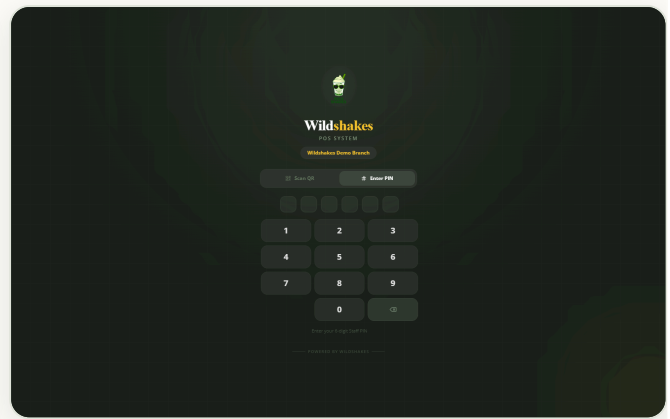
The very first screen a new tablet shows. Only franchisee or master_admin accounts are accepted here — a cashier or manager PIN will not work at this step.

After entering owner credentials, the tablet lists that owner's active branches (or every branch, for Master Admin) to choose from. If a branch is already bound to a different tablet, the app shows an "Override Claim" warning and requires an explicit confirmation before taking over — this immediately logs the other tablet out, so it's only meant for genuine device replacement.

Step 2 — Cashier Sign-In



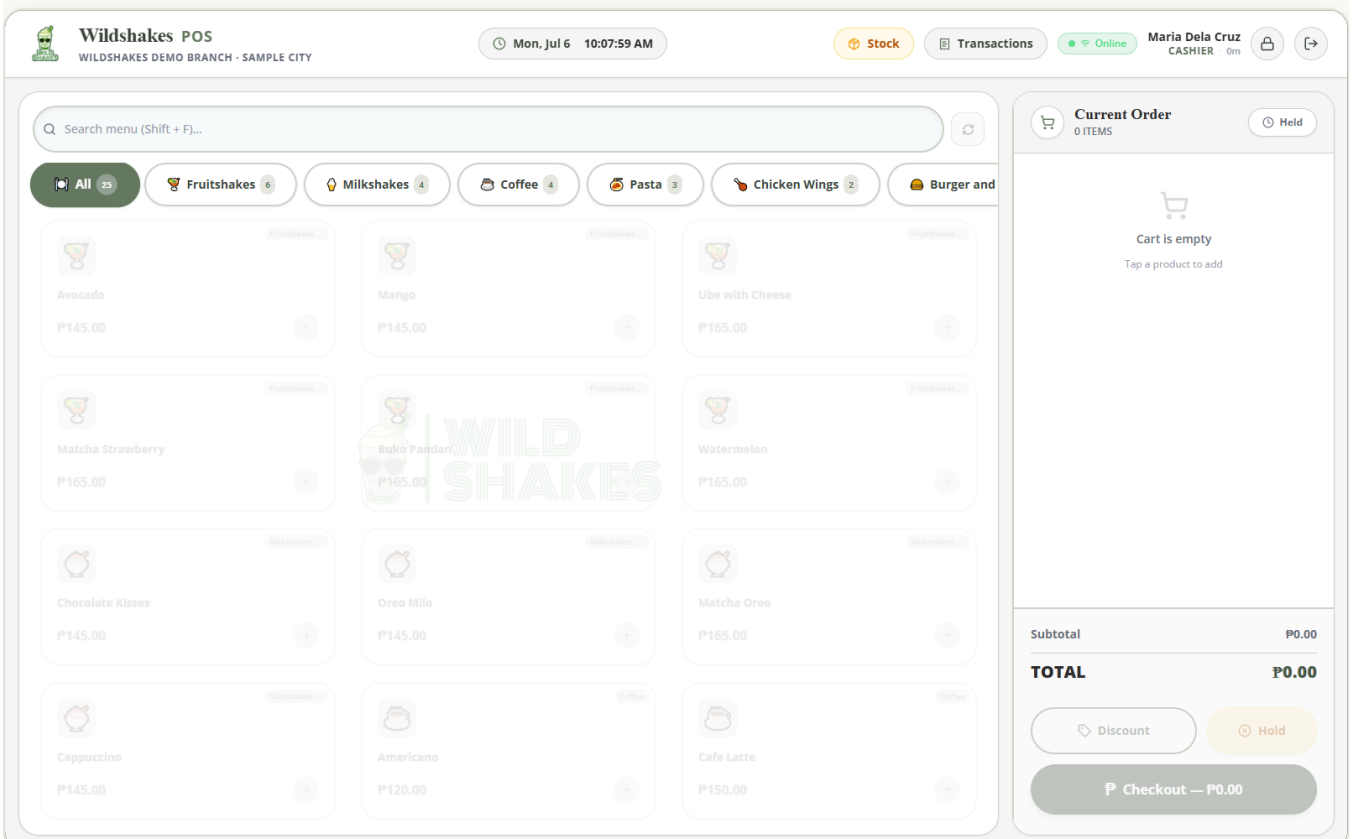
LIVE SCREENSHOT QR tab — scan a staff QR card to sign in instantly.



LIVE SCREENSHOT PIN tab — a 6-digit keypad; the 6th digit submits automatically.

PIN lockout: after 5 wrong attempts, PIN entry locks for 30 seconds with a visible countdown. This is a throttle against casual guessing — it survives a page refresh, but is explicitly not a defense against someone with physical access to the tablet.

Once signed in, the cashier lands on the main POS screen, ready to take orders:

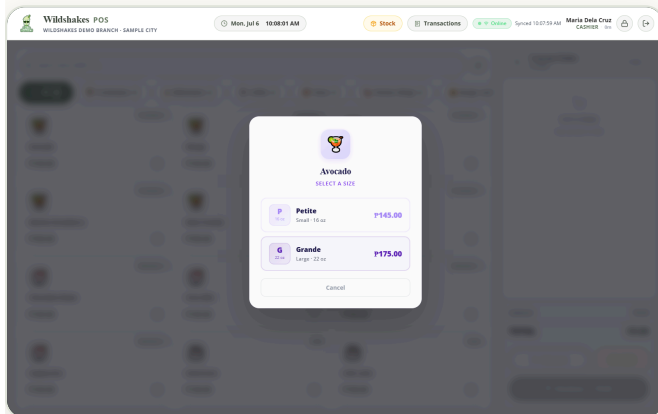


LIVE SCREENSHOT The main workspace — product menu on the left (70%), current order on the right (30%). The header shows the branch name, a live clock, connection status, and the signed-in cashier's name, role and how long they've been signed in.

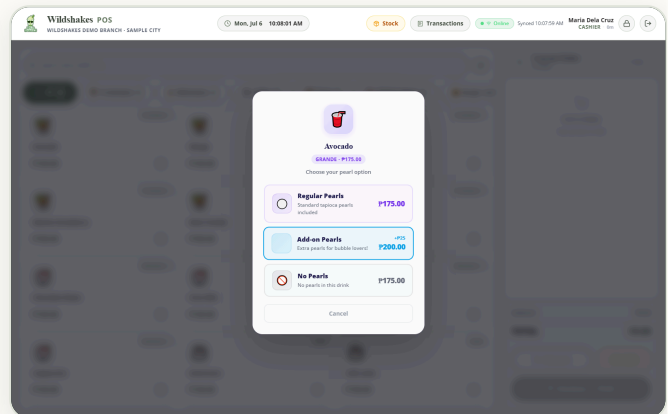
B1. Taking an Order

Tapping a product adds it straight to the cart — except for three product types that ask a follow-up question first:

Fruitshakes & Milkshakes — size, then pearls



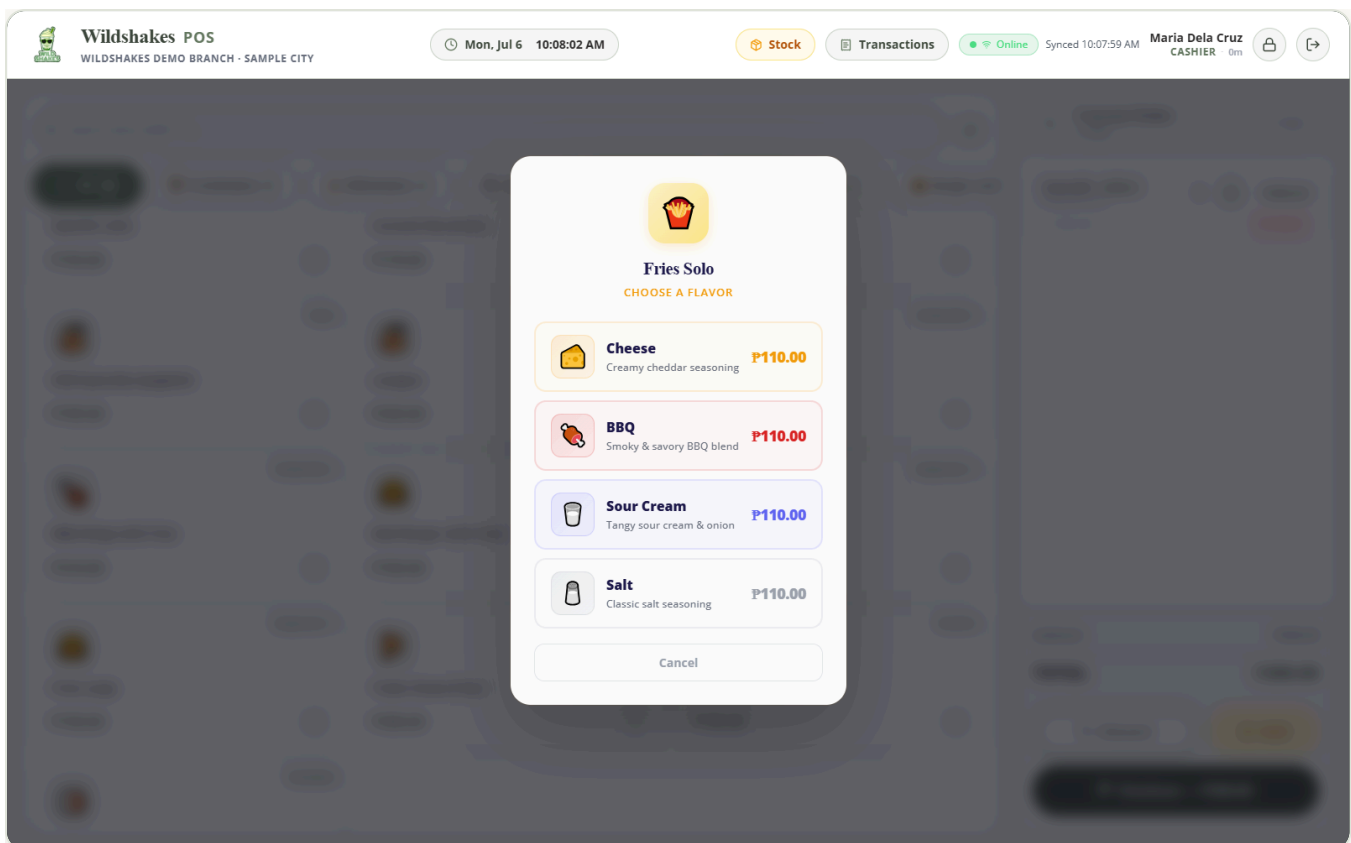
LIVE SCREENSHOT Petite (16oz) vs. Grande (22oz).



LIVE SCREENSHOT Pearls picker opens automatically right after a size is chosen.

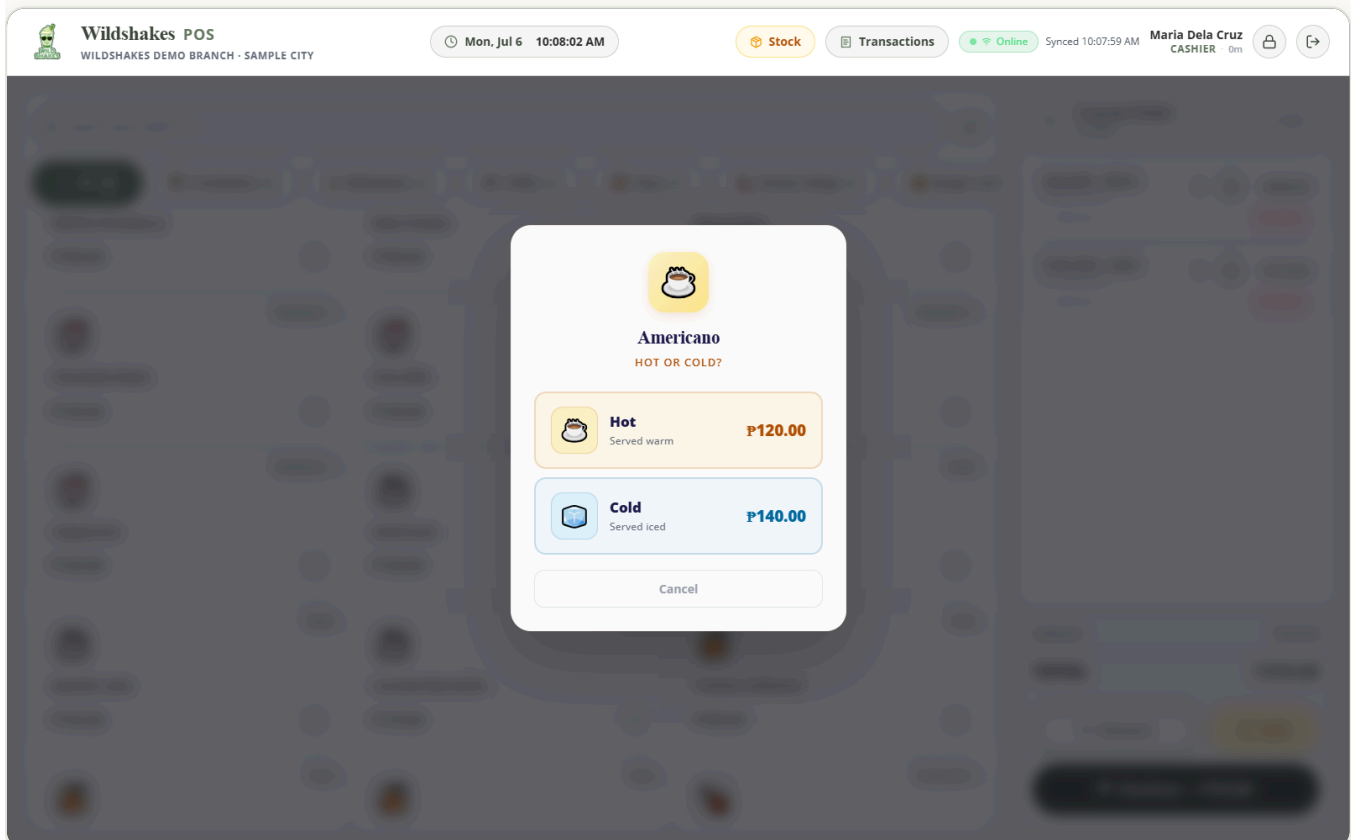
Pearls options are Regular Pearls (included), Add-on Pearls (+₱25), or No Pearls — this second step is never skippable for a shake.

Fries — flavor picker



LIVE SCREENSHOT Any product with "fries" in its name (Fries Solo, Fries Large, or a wings meal that includes fries) prompts for a flavor: Cheese, BBQ, Sour Cream, or Salt. A flavor that's been marked sold out in Stock Control (see B7) shows greyed-out here and can't be selected.

Coffee — hot or cold



LIVE SCREENSHOT

Coffee items are stored as separate Hot/Iced variants behind the scenes; the cashier just picks a temperature and the correct price is applied automatically.

The cart in action

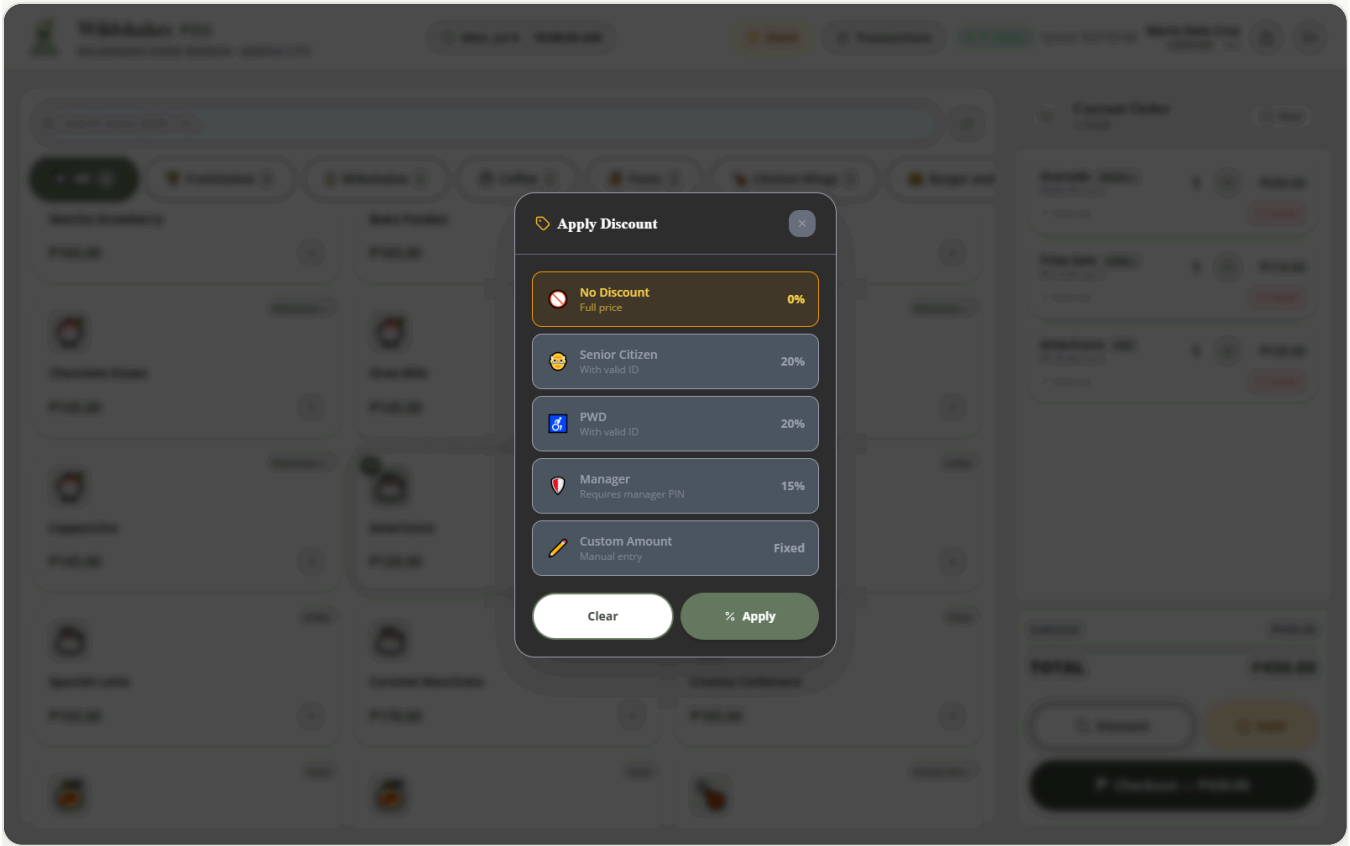
The screenshot displays the Wildshakes POS interface. At the top, the header includes the logo, branch name (WILDSHAKES DEMO BRANCH · SAMPLE CITY), date and time (Mon, Jul 6 10:08:03 AM), status (Online), and cashier name (Maria Dela Cruz). Below the header is a search bar and a category filter bar with options like All, Fruitshakes, Milkshakes, Coffee, Pasta, Chicken Wings, and Burger and. The main menu grid shows various items with their prices and category tags. On the right, the 'Current Order' section lists 3 items: Avocado Grande, Fries Solo Cheese, and Americano Hot, each with quantity controls and a price. The subtotal is P430.00, and the total is P430.00. At the bottom right, there are buttons for Discount, Hold, and Checkout.

LIVE SCREENSHOT

A cart with a Fruitshake (Grande, Add-on Pearls), Fries (Cheese) and a Coffee (Hot). Each line has +/- quantity buttons, an editable note, and a **Cancel** toggle — cancelling an item strikes it through and removes it from the total, but keeps it visible on the order for the record, rather than deleting it outright.

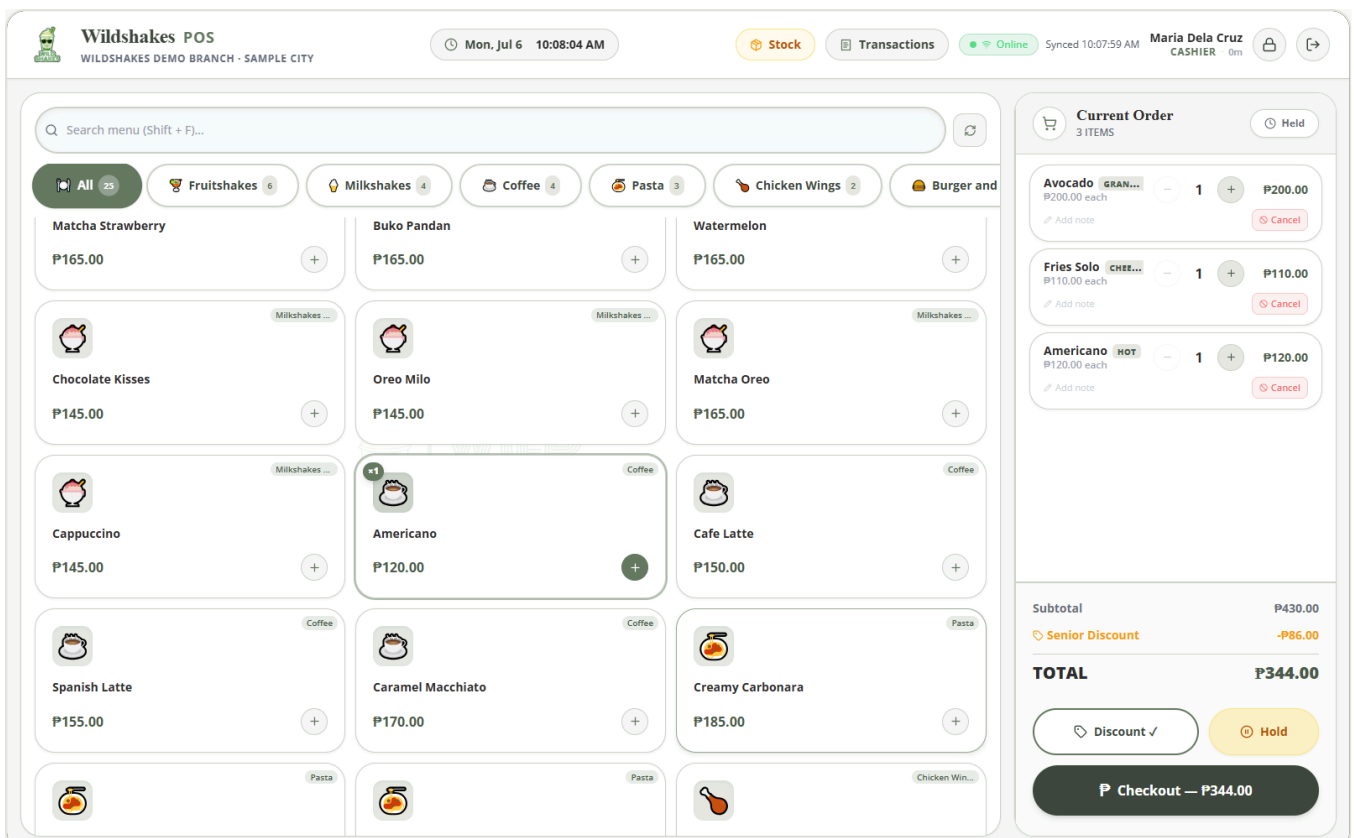
Keyboard shortcuts (tablet with a keyboard, or for training on a laptop): Shift+C Checkout · Shift+H Hold · Shift+D Discount · Shift+X Clear Cart · Shift+F Focus Search.

B2. Discounts



LIVE SCREENSHOT The five discount tiers.

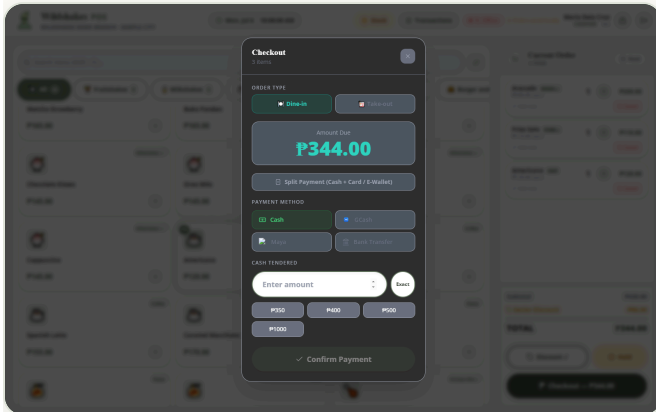
TYPE	RATE	REQUIREMENT
 No Discount	0%	—
 Senior Citizen	20%	Valid ID
 PWD	20%	Valid ID
 Manager	15%	Requires a Manager PIN — a cashier applying this tier is stopped at Checkout until a manager or investor authorizes it.
 Custom Amount	Fixed ₱	Manual entry, capped at the order subtotal.



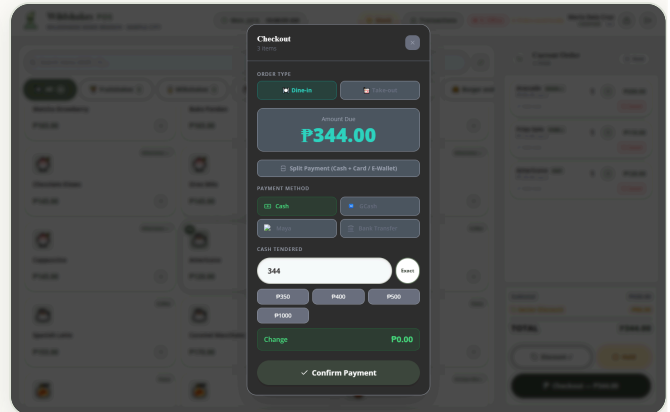
LIVE SCREENSHOT Once applied, the discount shows as its own line in the cart total, and the Discount button itself shows a checkmark so the cashier can see at a glance that one is active.

B3. Checkout & Payments

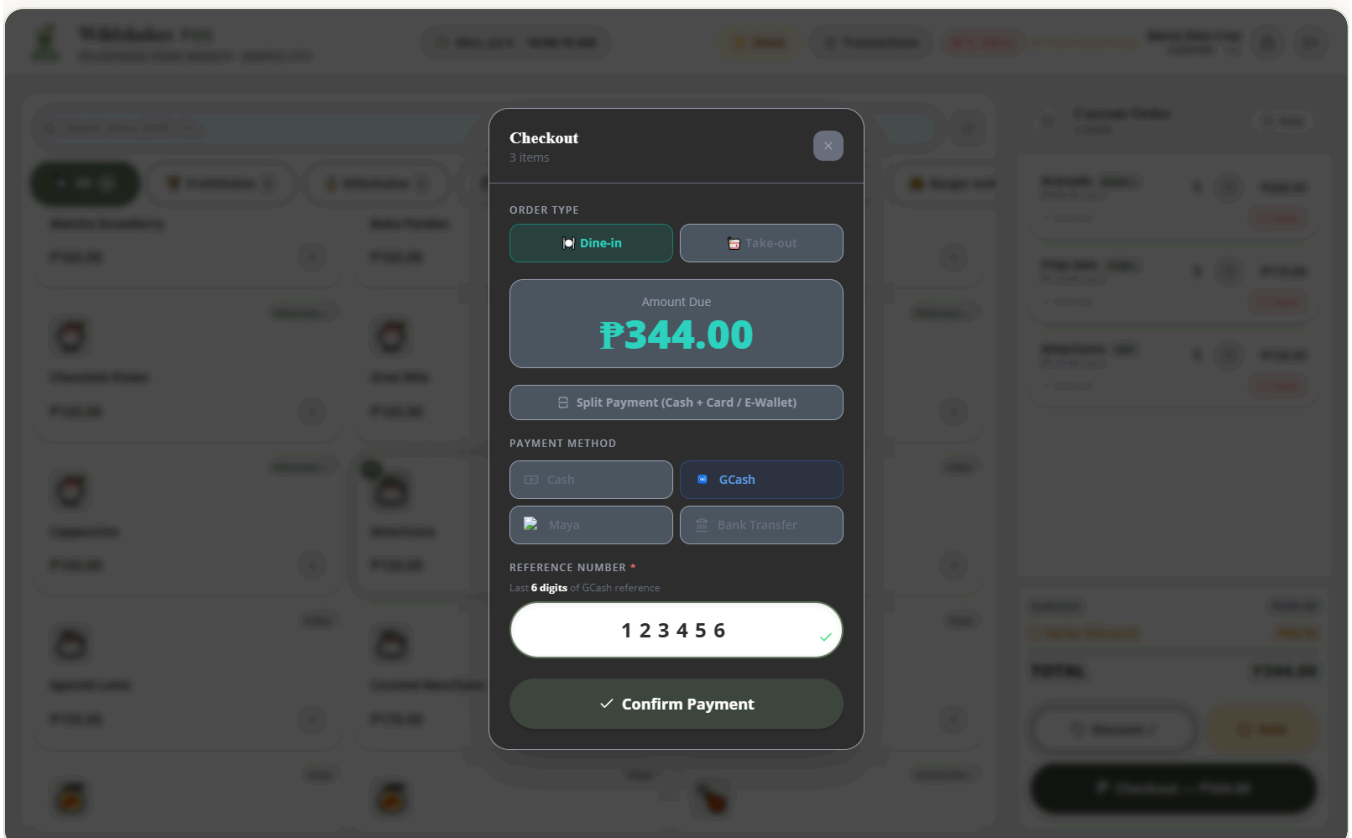
Checkout starts with Order Type (Dine-in / Take-out — locked to Pickup automatically for delivery orders), then the amount due, then payment.



LIVE SCREENSHOT Cash — smart quick-amount buttons round up to the nearest sensible bill.



LIVE SCREENSHOT "Exact" auto-fills the tendered amount; Change is calculated instantly.



LIVE SCREENSHOT GCash / Maya require the last 6 digits of the reference number (Bank Transfer requires 5, plus a bank selection); the field turns green with a checkmark once the correct digit count is entered.

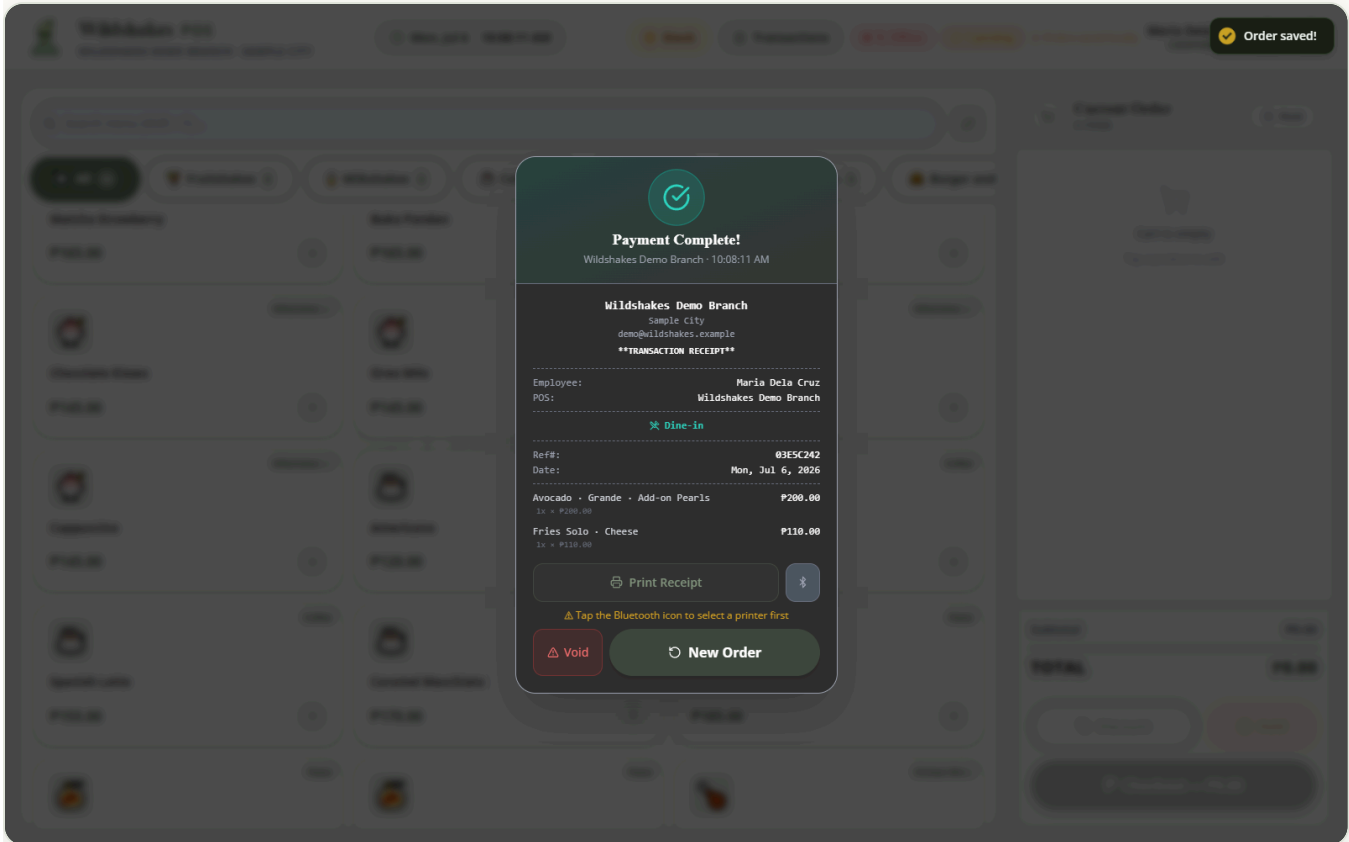
Split payments

Toggling "Split Payment" lets the cashier enter two or more payments (e.g. part Cash, part GCash), each with its own method, amount and reference number. The order can only be confirmed once those payments together cover the total — a running "Collected / Remaining" readout tracks progress. This shows up afterward as a "split" payment, with the exact breakdown kept for reporting.

Confirming payment

Pressing "**Confirm Payment**" saves the sale to the tablet immediately (see B8), gives an early heads-up if any ingredient is running low based on the Smart Inventory count, and opens the receipt.

B4. Receipts, Kitchen Tickets & Printing



LIVE SCREENSHOT

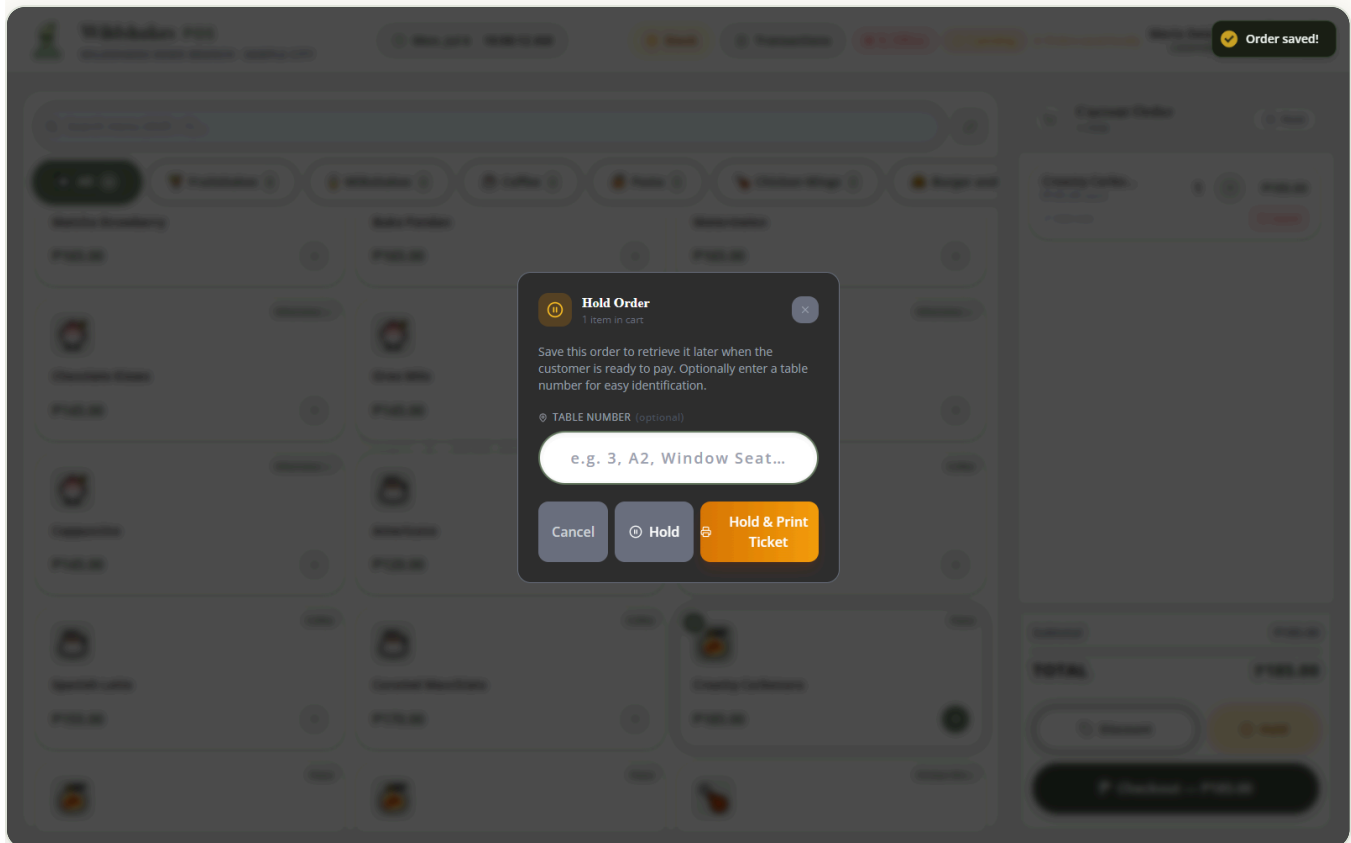
The on-screen receipt — styled like a thermal print preview, with branch details, itemized lines, totals, and payment breakdown. The footer disclaimer ("TRANSACTION RECEIPT ONLY") reflects that this is a POS record, not a BIR official receipt.

From here the cashier can **Print Receipt** (via a paired Bluetooth thermal printer — this only works inside the installed tablet app, not in a desktop browser), pick/change the paired printer, **Void** the sale with a required reason, or start a **New Order**.

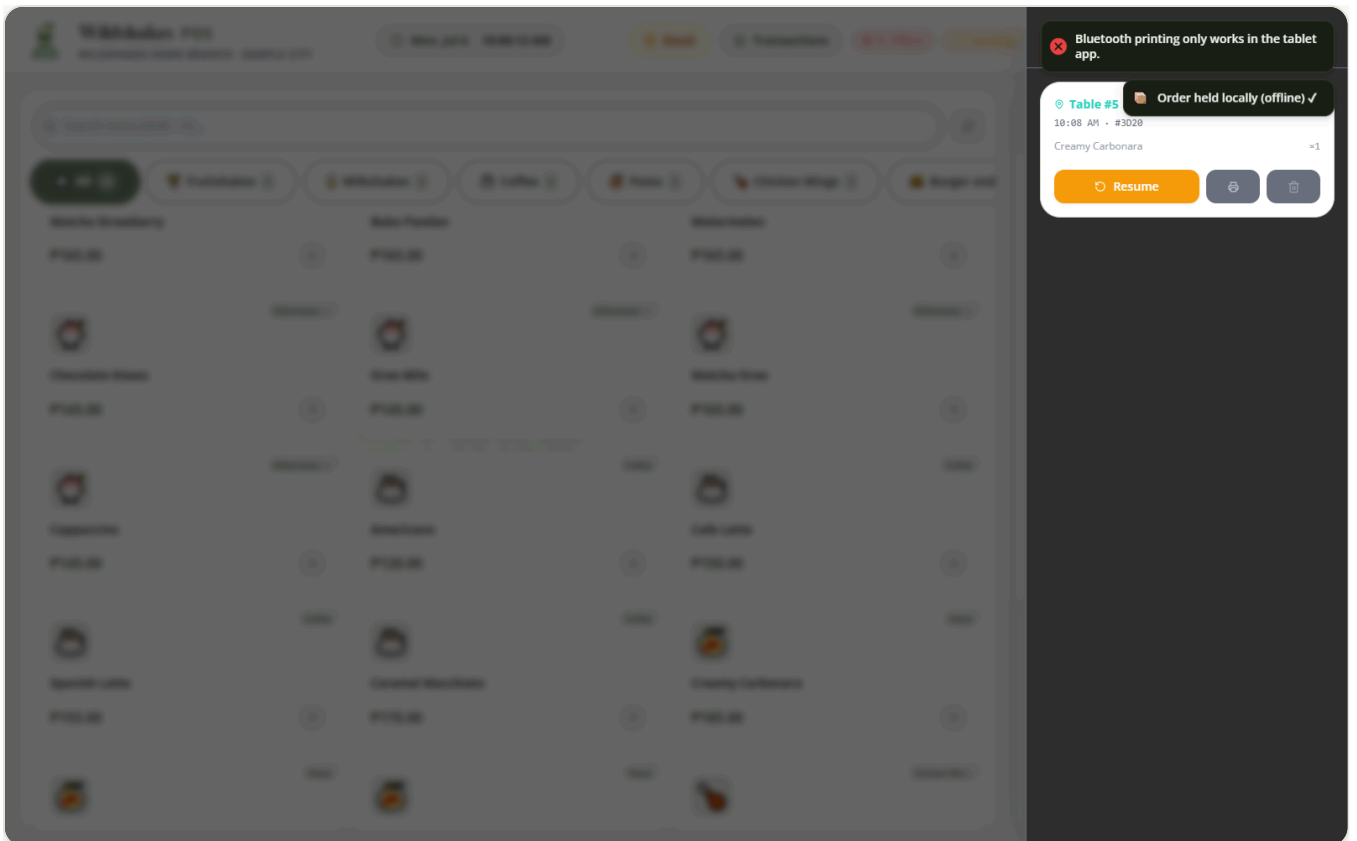
Kitchen tickets are a separate, simpler print-out (Item + Qty only, no prices) triggered by "Send to Kitchen" / "Hold & Print Ticket" — designed for the kitchen or bar station, and never includes cancelled items.

B5. Hold / Pending Orders

"Hold" saves the current cart and clears the register for the next customer — used for dine-in tables that haven't paid yet, or an order started while another is mid-payment.

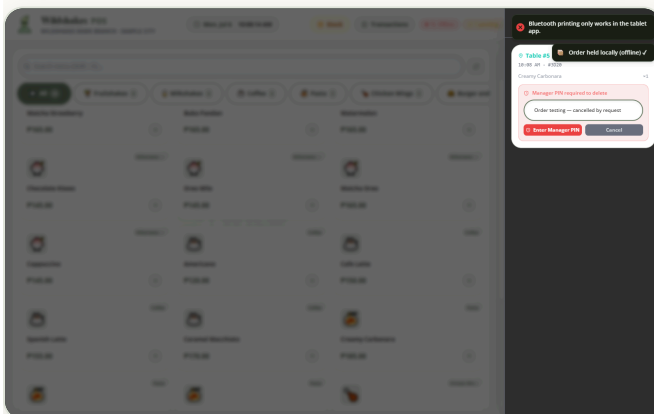


LIVE SCREENSHOT An optional table number identifies the order; "Hold & Print Ticket" saves it and immediately sends a kitchen ticket. If an already-held order is being updated, its table number is locked (shown with a ) so it can't drift.

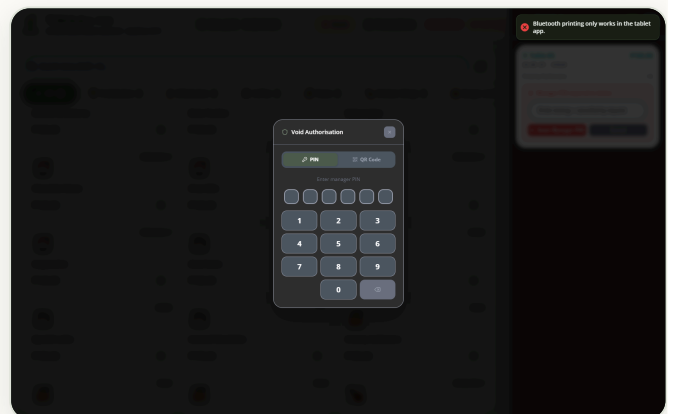


LIVE SCREENSHOT The Held Orders drawer — table number, time, and item list for every order currently on hold. **Resume** brings it back into the active cart (clearing whatever's currently in the cart, with a confirmation if it isn't empty); the printer icon reprints its kitchen ticket.

Deleting a held order requires a manager



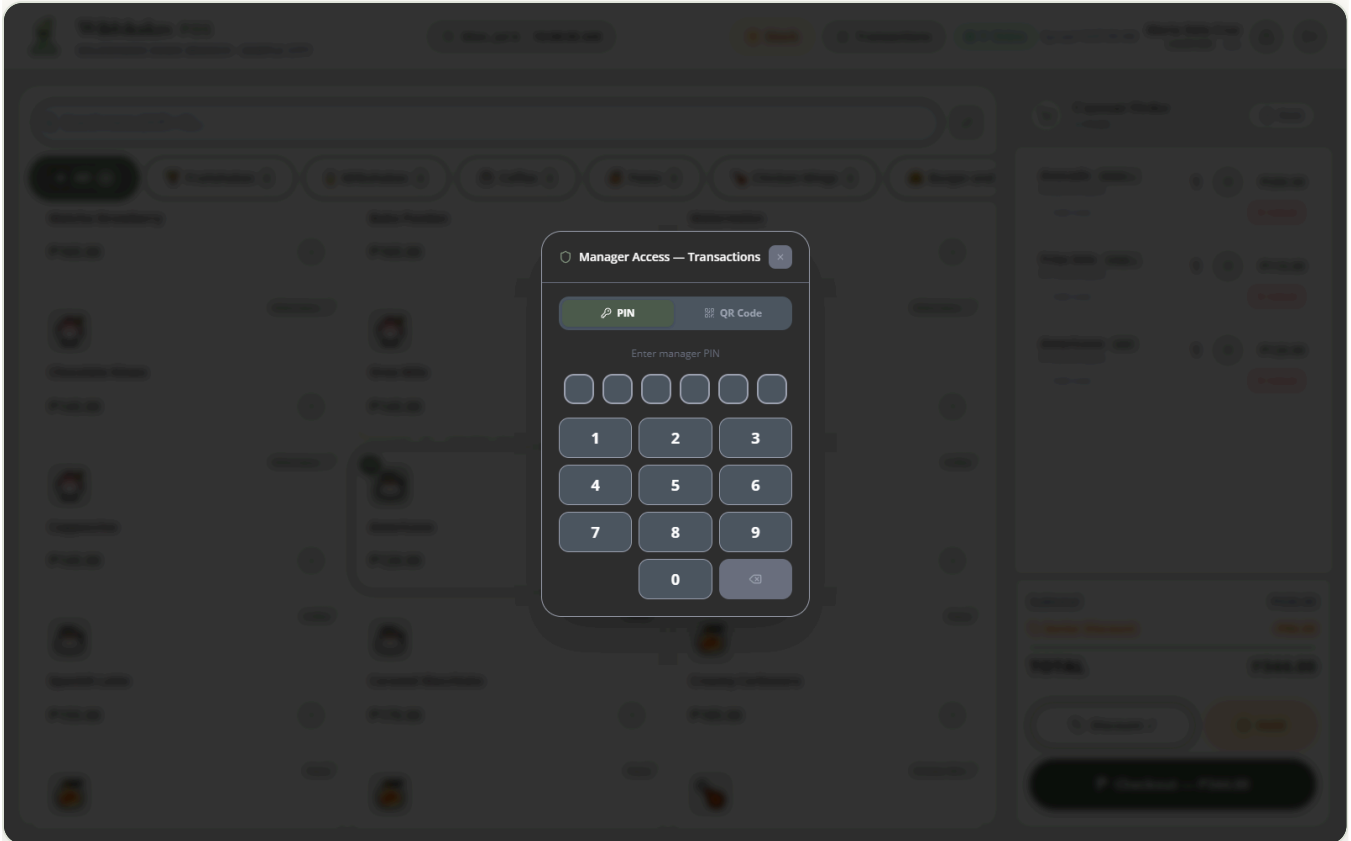
LIVE SCREENSHOT The trash icon opens a reason field right there on the card.



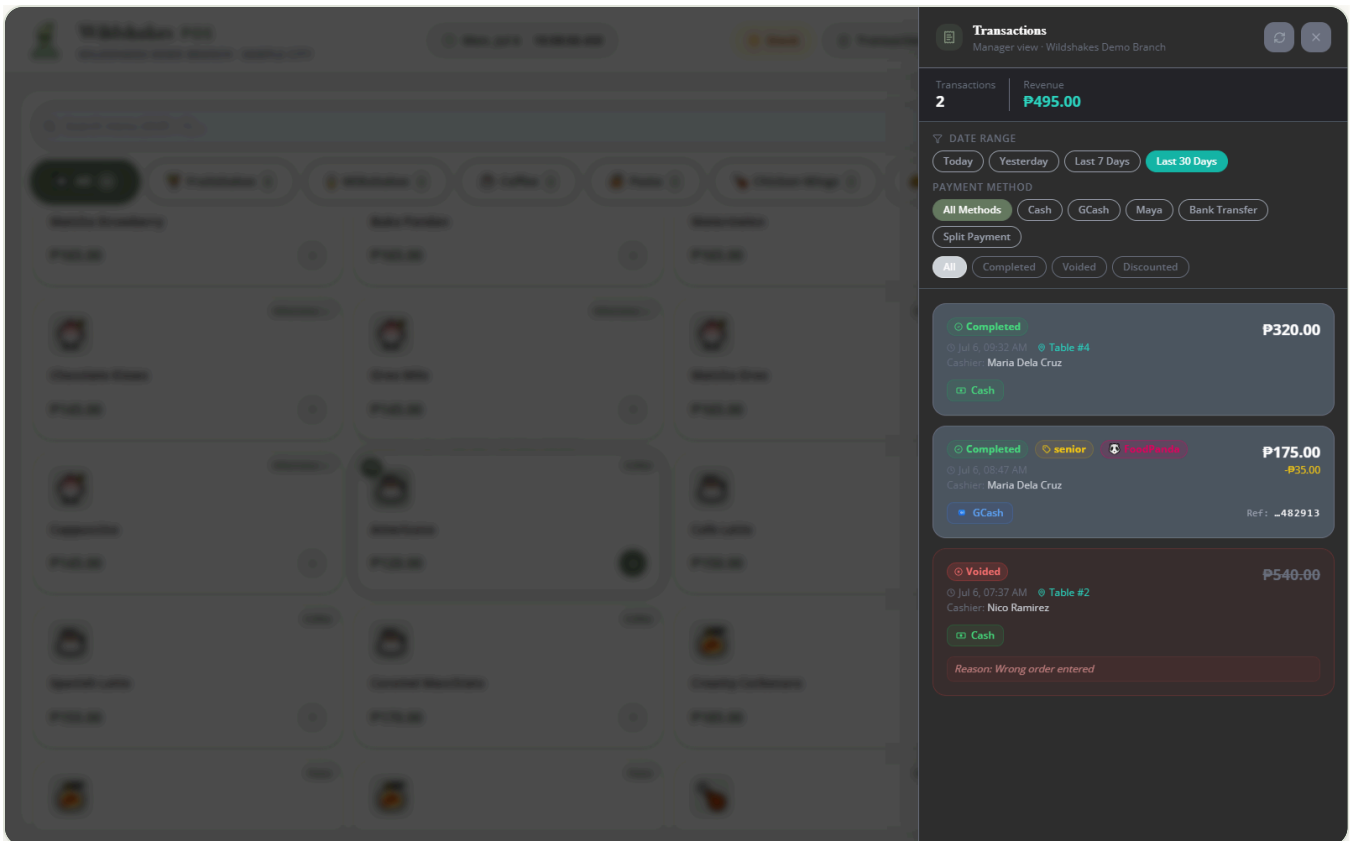
LIVE SCREENSHOT "Enter Manager PIN" then opens the same Manager PIN gate used everywhere else.

B6. Manager Security Features

One reusable "Manager PIN" gate protects five different sensitive actions in the POS app. A Manager or Investor who's already signed in sails through instantly — the gate only stops someone signed in as a Cashier.

**LIVE SCREENSHOT**

Same gate, five contexts: Manager-tier discount escalation, voiding a completed sale, deleting a held order, releasing the POS device, and — shown here — opening the Transactions view.

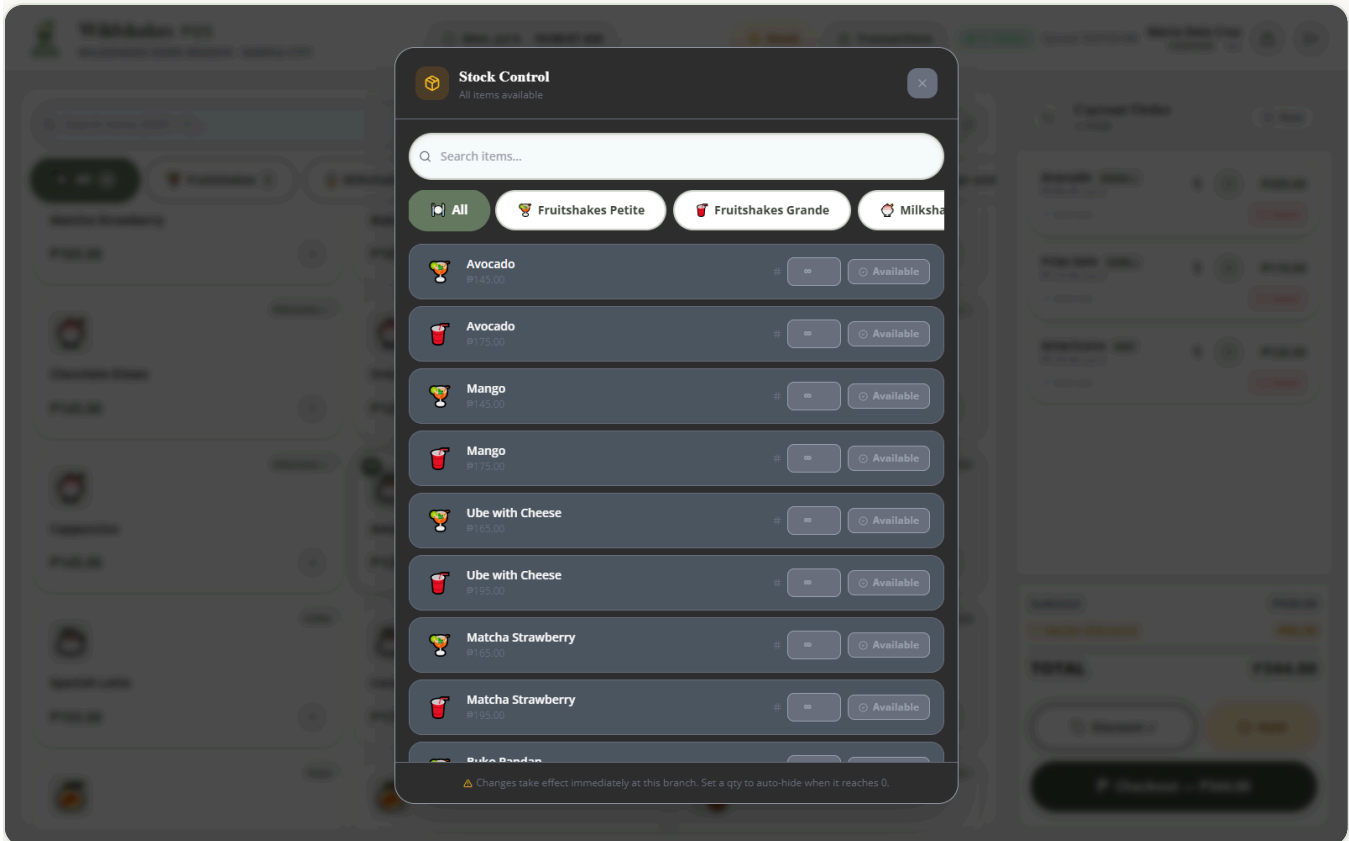


LIVE SCREENSHOT Once unlocked, Transactions shows every sale at this branch with filters for date range, payment method and status (Completed / Voided / Discounted) — including a voided sale's recorded reason.

Every void is on record: whether it's a completed sale or a held order being deleted, the action creates a permanent entry showing which manager authorized it, the reason given, and the exact time — this can't be recreated or faked after the fact.

B7. Stock Control

The **"Stock"** button in the header opens a quick in-the-moment 86'd-item tool — separate from the Franchiser portal's Daily Inventory Check, and meant for fast changes mid-shift (e.g. "we just ran out of Avocado Grande").



LIVE SCREENSHOT Every product, plus four special "Fries Flavor" entries so a specific fries flavor can be 86'd without hiding fries entirely. A quantity can optionally be set (leave blank for ∞ unlimited) — the item automatically flips to Sold Out once its quantity hits zero.

Changes here take effect immediately at this branch only. This is the exact same setting the Franchiser portal's "Menu Availability" page also shows and can change — they're just two different places to see and adjust it.

B8. Offline-First: No Internet? No Problem

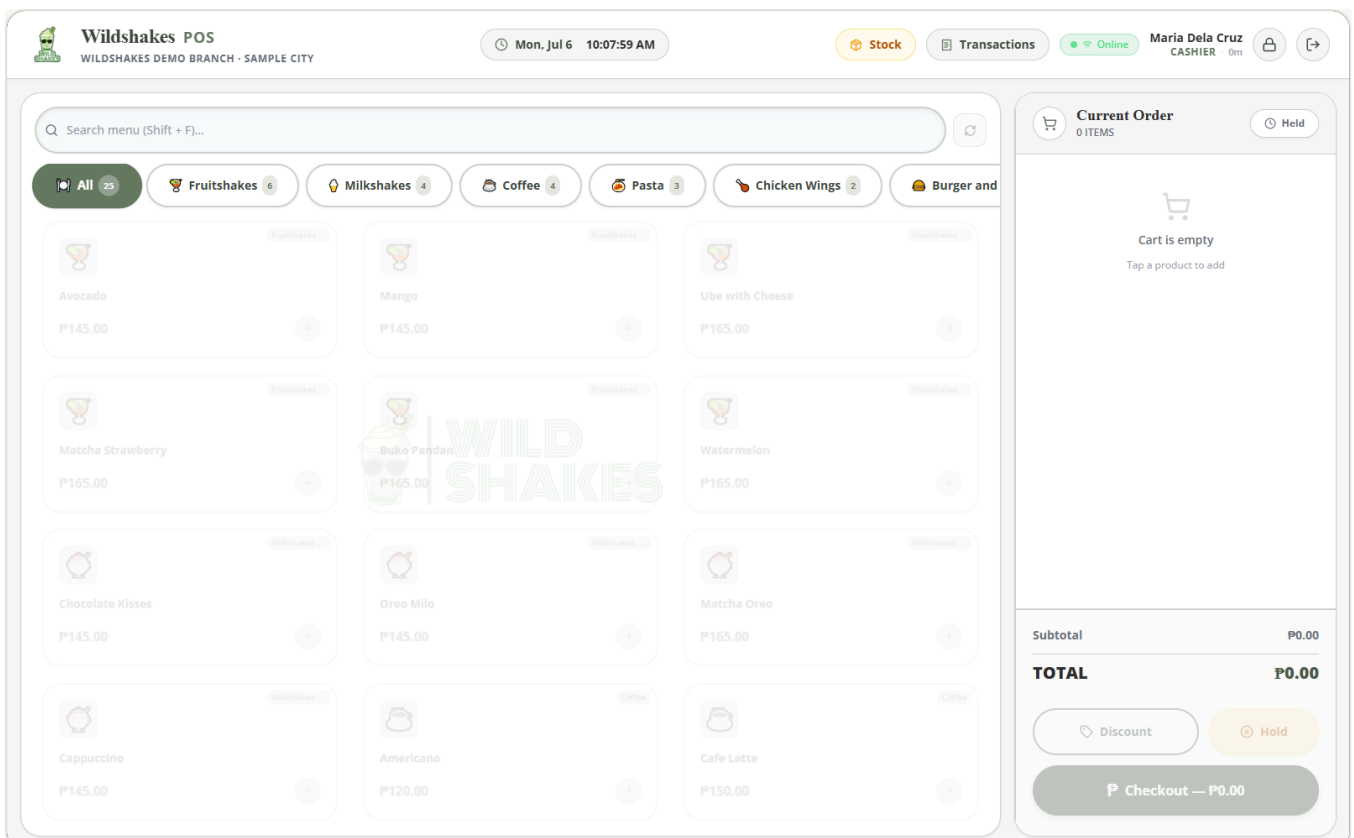
This is the single most important design decision in the POS app: **a spotty or dead internet connection at the branch should never stop a sale.**

What happens every time the cashier does something

1. The action (a completed sale, a hold, a void, a security log entry) is saved on the tablet itself **first** — this happens instantly and always works, whether the internet is up or not.
2. The app immediately tries to send that same information to head office's system in the background.
3. If that doesn't go through (no signal, weak signal, a brief hiccup on the other end), it simply stays marked "waiting to send" on the tablet — nothing is lost, and the cashier's screen shows exactly the same result either way, just a slightly different confirmation message (e.g. "Order held ✓" when connected vs. "Order held locally (offline) ✓" when not).
4. Every 30 seconds, and right after every checkout or void, the app quietly tries again to send anything still waiting.

What still works with zero signal

- **Cashier PIN/QR sign-in** — the tablet keeps its own saved copy of the active staff PINs, updated every time it successfully connects.
- **Manager PIN approval** — same saved copy; a manager can approve a void or discount with no signal at all.
- **The product menu** — kept saved on the tablet, and only updated from head office's system when a connection is available.
- **Smart Inventory low-stock warnings** — a running count of ingredients left, kept on the tablet and updated instantly with every sale; this is just an early heads-up for the cashier — the official count is confirmed centrally once the sale goes through.



The connection status indicator in the header (top-right, next to the clock) is the cashier's at-a-glance signal: green "● Online / Synced" when everything is caught up, or amber "N pending" with a button to try again, whenever sales are still waiting to go through.

Appendix — Security & Troubleshooting Notes

Security design summary

- **Owner-only staff management** is enforced by the system itself, not just hidden in the menus — a staff account can never create other staff or change what panels they can see, even if it happens to have every panel checked.
- **Panel access is checked fresh every time a page opens**, not just remembered from when they first logged in — cutting off a staff member's access takes effect on their very next click, with no delay.
- **PIN lockout** on the POS sign-in screen (5 attempts, 30-second cooldown) slows down casual guessing; it is explicitly not a substitute for physically securing the tablet.
- **The Manager PIN screen** is one shared safeguard protecting: Manager-discount approval, voiding a completed sale, deleting a held order, viewing Transactions as a cashier, and releasing the POS device.
- **Every void and discount creates a permanent record** of who authorized it, why, and when — cancelled cart items are kept (struck-through) in the order rather than deleted, for the same reason.
- **Commissary managers can only tag catalog items for their own franchisees** — the system prevents them from ever changing a visibility setting Head Office assigned to a branch outside their network.

Common questions

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
Tablet shows "Offline" for a while	Nothing urgent — keep selling normally. Everything is saved on the tablet and will be sent through automatically once the connection returns. Use the amber "N pending" button to try again once signal is back.
Cashier forgot their PIN	A Manager or the Franchisee owner resets it from Franchiser Portal → My Staff → the staff member's entry →  "Change" next to their PIN.
Wrong item rung up, already paid	Open the receipt (or find it in Transactions), press Void , enter a reason, and have a Manager authorize it with their PIN. Do not simply delete or re-ring the item — there needs to be a proper record of who approved it and why.
Replacing a lost/broken tablet	Install the POS app on the new tablet, run Device Setup with the owner's email/password, and select the branch — the app will warn that the old device will be logged out; confirm to proceed.
An item needs to come off the menu right now, mid-shift	Use the Stock button on the POS screen (B7) for an instant, this-branch-only change. For a permanent price or name change, that's done by Head Office in Menu Management (A1.7).
Staff member's web portal access no longer needed	Their owner (Franchisee / Commissary manager / Master Admin) revokes it from the relevant Staff page — this removes their web login but leaves their POS PIN/QR untouched.

